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RETURN

Create Ukraine 2026: New Call for Global Diaspora to Return and Rebuild

KSE Foundation's Create Ukraine programme has launched a new recruitment cycle ahead of URC 2026, inviting Ukrainian professionals worldwide to return home and apply their international expertise to Ukraine's reconstruction. The programme matches diaspora talent with concrete roles in recovery institutions and private sector organisations.

3R: Direct Return activation mechanism — a structured, institutionalised pipeline converting diaspora interest into employment offers within Ukraine's recovery ecosystem.

URC 2026 Diaspora Session: IOM Takeaways on Engaging Ukrainians Abroad

IOM's recap of the URC 2026 Gdańsk discussion outlines policy levers for strengthening diaspora engagement and supporting voluntary return, including information campaigns, legal facilitation, and bilateral labour agreements. The session highlighted that trust-building and concrete incentives are prerequisites for meaningful return flows.

3R: Provides a multilateral policy framework for Return, identifying specific barriers and enablers discussed at the highest-level reconstruction forum of 2026.

UKRAINE.IOM.INT

30 Young Diaspora Leaders at URC 2026: 1.5–2 Million Youth Abroad

Razom for Ukraine facilitated participation of 30 young Ukrainian leaders from the EU, Switzerland, and the US at URC 2026, spotlighting the scale of youth displacement — between 1.5 and 2 million young Ukrainians currently live abroad. The initiative aims to channel their voices into recovery planning and build bridges for eventual return.

3R: Quantifies the youth Return opportunity and demonstrates civil-society-driven diaspora activation as a complementary channel to government programmes.

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RECRUIT

From Inactivity to Productivity: Economic Case for Integrating Women into Ukraine's Labour Market (VoxUkraine PDF)

A VoxUkraine study models the macroeconomic impact of activating unemployed and economically inactive Ukrainian women through retraining and employment programmes. Findings show significant GDP uplift potential, positioning women's labour integration as the single largest untapped domestic recruitment reservoir available to Ukraine right now.

3R: Core Recruit signal — quantifies the domestic talent pool that can partially offset diaspora losses without waiting for Return flows to materialise.

VOXUKRAINE.ORG

Women's Labour Market Integration: 62% of Firms Report Shortages (VoxUkraine Article)

VoxUkraine's accessible summary of the full study reports that as of December 2025, 62% of Ukrainian enterprises face labour shortages as the dominant business constraint. The article argues that targeted upskilling of women and removal of structural barriers — childcare, legal discrimination, mobility constraints — is the fastest scalable recruitment lever.

3R: Reinforces Recruit priority with enterprise-level demand data and proposes actionable policy interventions linked to specific skill gap categories.

VOXUKRAINE.ORG

ILO Local Employment Partnerships in Mykolaiv & Odesa: Demand-Driven Skilling

ILO's LEP programme in Mykolaiv and Odesa operates as an employer-led skilling, upskilling, and reskilling mechanism aligning training curricula directly with vacancy demand. The programme fills acute skill gaps in war-affected southern regions by rapidly converting inactive or displaced workers into job-ready candidates.

3R: Operational Recruit model — demonstrates how employer-demand-driven local partnerships can scale recruitment in regions with high displacement and skill mismatches.

ILO.ORG

ILO LEP National Overview: Addressing Labour Market Challenges Through Local Partnerships

This ILO action report documents the broader national rollout of LEPs, covering employer-led training, reskilling initiatives, and vocational education reform. It establishes LEPs as a scalable infrastructure for systematically closing skill gaps across multiple Ukrainian oblasts simultaneously.

3R: Provides the systemic Recruit infrastructure layer — moving beyond pilot projects toward national-scale skill gap remediation tied to real employer demand.

ILO.ORG

KSE Institute Labour Market Study: 213K Active Vacancies Analysed at URC 2026

KSE Institute presented a June 2026 labour market analysis at URC 2026 covering 213,000 active civilian vacancies. The data reveals a post-January recovery trajectory and maps sectoral and geographic skill demand patterns critical for targeting recruitment and reskilling investments.

3R: Provides the empirical vacancy map needed to prioritise Recruit interventions — showing where skill gaps are largest and which sectors are driving post-war labour demand.

KSE.UA

GLOBAL CONTEXT

Ukrainian Diaspora in the United States: Migration Policy Institute Profile

MPI's profile by Jeanne Batalova documents the significant growth of the Ukrainian immigrant population in the US following Russia's 2022 full-scale invasion, capturing demographic and labour market characteristics of this diaspora cohort. This data contextualises the scale of US-based Ukrainian talent that Return and engagement programmes must compete to attract.

3R: Global context for Return strategy — quantifies and profiles the North American diaspora segment, the hardest cohort to repatriate due to higher integration levels and longer distances.

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Ukraine PM at URC 2026 Gdańsk: 'We Fight, We Suffer, We Stay Resilient'

Ukraine's Prime Minister used the URC 2026 platform in Gdańsk to signal national resilience and rally international support for recovery, framing human capital restoration as integral to reconstruction. The political messaging directly supports the conditions needed for diaspora confidence in returning — security narrative, institutional stability, and international backing.

3R: Political and reputational context — high-level signalling at URC 2026 shapes the trust environment that underpins all three Rs, particularly diaspora willingness to Return.

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